
WELCOME



PARENT GUIDE: SUPPORTING YOUR PITCHER

Hi, I'm ALAINA



Hey there! I'm Alaina Valdez and I'm so excited to be working with you.

First up: a little about me. I am the founder of Fifth Gear Pitching. My goal was simple: to make it easier for pitchers to get the proper tools they need.

I am excited to work with you and help you learn about your pitcher and help supporting your child's success and dreams!

SUPPORTING YOUR PITCHER

Parents play a huge role in a pitcher's journey. From car rides to practice, late-night tournaments, and emotional ups and downs, your support can shape their confidence and love for the game. This guide offers tips on how to be the best support system for your pitcher, from youth softball all the way to college dreams.

Be Their Encourager, Not Their Coach

After a tough game, kids don't need technical critiques—they need emotional support. Leave the mechanics to their coach and focus on encouraging effort, not just results.

Create a Positive Practice Environment

Help them stay motivated by:

- Reminding them why they love the game
- Being patient during frustrating phases
- Avoiding comparisons to other players

Game-Day Support

What helps most on game day:

- Keep pre-game talk simple: 'Have fun and do your best.'
- Avoid adding pressure like 'We need this win.'
- Celebrate effort, not just outcomes.

SUPPORTING YOUR PITCHER

Handling Struggles

Every pitcher has bad games. Instead of dwelling on mistakes, help them reflect on what they learned and what's next. Ask open-ended questions like, 'What felt good today? What do you want to work on next time?'

Balance and Perspective

Encourage your child to have other interests outside of softball. Burnout can happen quickly if the sport feels like a job.

Supporting Big Dreams

If your pitcher wants to play in college, remind them that their journey is a marathon, not a sprint. Your role is to support their goals while helping them stay grounded and healthy.

PARENT SUPPORT CHECKLIST

- ☐ Encouraged effort, not perfection
- ☐ Avoided adding pressure before games
- ☐ Celebrated small improvements
- ☐ Kept post-game talks positive and brief
- ☐ Helped maintain balance outside of softball